sent to a labour camp and later shot. In September 1932, Pavlik was found murdered, and Soviet authorities arrested and executed five of his family members, who allegedly killed him in revenge for the denunciation. The real story was far more complicated, but it didn't matter to the Soviet press. Pavlik became a martyr, and millions of Soviet children were taught to emulate him.[100] Many did.

For example, in 1934 a thirteen-year-old boy called Pronia Kolibin told the authorities that his hungry mother stole grain from the kolkhoz fields. His mother was arrested and presumably shot. Pronia was rewarded with a cash prize and a lot of positive media attention. The party organ *Pravda* published a poem Pronia wrote. Two of its lines read, 'You are a wrecker, Mother / I can live with you no more.'[101]

The Soviet attempt to control the family was reflected in a dark joke told in Stalin's day. Stalin visits a factory undercover and, conversing with a worker, he asks the man, 'Who is your father?'

'Stalin,' replies the worker.

'Who is your mother?'

'The Soviet Union,' the man responds.

'And what do you want to be?'

'An orphan.'[102]

At the time you could easily lose your liberty or your life for telling this joke, even if you told it in your own home to your closest family members. The most important lesson Soviet parents taught their children wasn't loyalty to the party or to Stalin. It was 'Keep your mouth shut.'[103] Few things in the Soviet Union were as dangerous as holding an open conversation.

PARTY AND CHURCH

You may wonder whether modern totalitarian institutions like the Nazi Party or the Soviet Communist Party were really all that different from earlier institutions like the Christian churches. After all, churches too believed in their infallibility, had priestly agents everywhere and sought to control the daily life of people down to their diet and sexual habits. Shouldn't we see the Catholic Church or the Eastern Orthodox Church as